

SWITCH OF PLAY TO FOUR GOALS

15 MIN

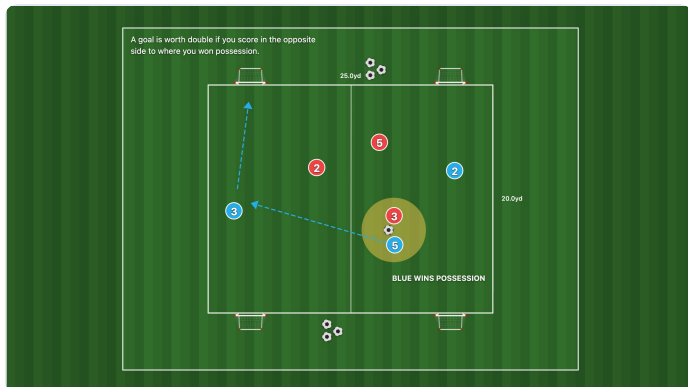
U8-U10

POSSESSION

PASSING

OBJECTIVE

Win the ball, then look for the open side before committing: switch play away from where you won it rather than driving at the nearest goal.



PREPARATION

25 x 20 yd area split into two halves with a line down the middle. Two small goals at each end, one in each half. Spare balls at both ends so play restarts straight away.

EQUIPMENT

- ☐ 4 small goals
- ☐ 6+ balls
- ☐ Cones
- ☐ Bibs (2 colors)

PLAYERS

5-8 players

Medium Grid

FIELD SIZE 25 x 20yd

ORGANIZATION

3v3 (or 4v4), no goalkeepers. Each team attacks the two goals at one end and defends the two at the other. A normal goal counts 1. A goal scored in the half opposite to where your team won the ball counts double. After a goal or when the ball goes out, restart from a spare ball.

RULES

- Score in either goal you're attacking: 1 point
- Score on the opposite side to where you won the ball: 2 points
- No goalkeepers
- Restart straight away from the spare balls

PROGRESSIONS

- Switched goals count triple, or only switched goals count
- Narrow the area (e.g. 25 x 15 yd) for more pressure and quicker decisions
- A touch limit, set to what your players can manage

REGRESSIONS

- Add a neutral who plays for whichever team has the ball
- Make the area bigger (e.g. 30 x 25 yd)
- Drop the double-goal rule until players can keep the ball

COACHING POINTS

- Look to the far side before the ball arrives
- First touch away from pressure, toward the open side
- When your team wins it, get wide on the far side
- If the near goal is open, take it, since switching isn't the only right answer

QUESTIONS FOR PLAYERS

- "Where did we win the ball, and which side is open now?"
- "Who can see the far goal?"
- "When is the near goal the better choice?"